STORYCAST

Research & Planning Document

Three-page accessible audio and video storytelling microsite

Project overview

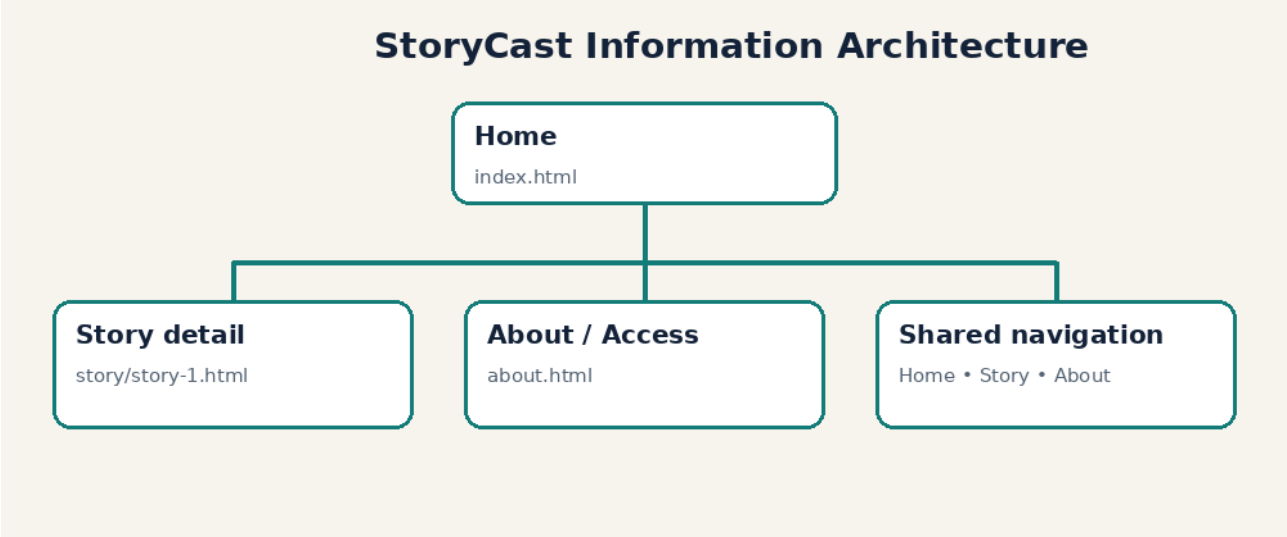
StoryCast is a proposed microsite for presenting short stories through readable text, audio, and video. It prioritises clear information architecture, responsive layouts, semantic HTML, and equivalent ways to access story content. The featured example, “The Power of Small Actions,” is fictional and is labelled as such in the interface.

Objectives

• Create three connected pages: Home, Story Detail, and About / Access.
• Provide the featured story as video, audio, and a transcript.
• Use semantic HTML5, Sass tokens/partials, vanilla JavaScript, Grid/Flexbox, and a container query.
• Design for keyboard use, visible focus, responsive reflow, captions, and transcripts.

Sitemap and information architecture

Home is the entry point. It links to Story Detail and About / Access. Shared navigation appears on every page, and each page offers a route back to Home. Story Detail contains the video, audio, captions, and transcript.



Page inventory

Page	Purpose	Content
Home index.html	Introduce StoryCast and guide visitors to a story.	Hero, featured card, planned cards, shared navigation.
Story Detail story/story-1.html	Present one story in multiple accessible formats.	Fiction notice, video/captions, audio, full transcript.
About / Access about.html	Explain purpose and accessibility approach.	Principles, access checklist, limitations/contact note.

Visual direction

The concept uses deep navy for structure, teal for interactive and supporting surfaces, coral for emphasis, and warm neutral backgrounds. Generous whitespace, clear headings, rounded panels, and repeated navigation support scanability. The mockups are design concepts and should be compared with the final rendered website.

Wireframes

Low-fidelity layouts show the hierarchy before visual styling. Local files:
• Home: docs/mockups/wireframes/home-wireframe.png
• Story Detail: docs/mockups/wireframes/story-wireframe.png
• About / Access: docs/mockups/wireframes/about-wireframe.png

High-fidelity mockups

The mockups show the proposed palette, typography, card system, media layout, and footer. Local files:
• Home: docs/mockups/high-fidelity/home-mockup.png
• Story Detail: docs/mockups/high-fidelity/story-mockup.png
• About / Access: docs/mockups/high-fidelity/about-mockup.png

Figma links

These supplied PNGs are local repository artefacts, not published Figma documents. If Figma URLs are mandatory, recreate/import the screens in Figma and replace these placeholders with real share links:
Wireframe Figma URL: [Add real share URL]
High-fidelity Figma URL: [Add real share URL]

Technology and accessibility plan

Semantic HTML5 provides page structure and native media controls. Sass partials separate colours, typography, and spacing. Vanilla JavaScript progressively enhances the mobile navigation. Grid and Flexbox create responsive layouts; a container query adapts a card component. WebVTT provides captions. Planned accessibility work includes landmarks, heading order, skip link, keyboard-operable navigation, visible focus, captions/transcript, reduced-motion support, contrast measurement, screen-reader checks, and reflow tests.

Testing plan and limitations

Test all links, navigation states, media playback, caption accuracy, transcript accuracy, narrow viewports, 200% zoom, keyboard focus, and colour contrast. Run an automated checker and manually review its findings. WCAG AA targets are 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large text and relevant UI components. The MP3/MP4 files are not included in this starter pack, the VTT is a draft, and the contact area does not submit data. Do not claim conformance until the finished implementation has been tested.